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The Second Law of Thermodynamics

Things fall

a p a r t ;

the

center

cannot hold.

I am at the computer, justified, when it happens. She is letting the dogs in. We operate in the same sphere but offset, a photon and an electron moving in a precarious and opposite symmetry. The unexpected is discouraged here, but inevitable. This is the last chance and I sense the beginning of disorder. After all, one cannot avoid entropy.

> "Well, you know when you're rocking in a rocking chair, and you go so far that you almost fall over backwards, but at the last instant you catch yourself? That's how I feel all the time."

There was the accident last year. She held the map. I drove off the map. We came to an intersection and, being mapless, a choice was made. She screamed. I veered.

"Good call?" "Right."

An object remains in a state of motion unless/until an external force is applied. We sold the car at a loss rather than fix it, rather than drive. I work from home now. She maintains a negative charge.

"Fort Lauderdale. It says Fort Lauderdale." "So?"

"Any idea who it could be?" "No."

"Could be a credit card company I suppose. Maybe somebody stole our identity. Should I answer?" "What if it's the person who stole your identity? You'd be talking to yourself."

I have to make a choice. She walks to the door of my office. I look at her. She wears pajamas. I theorize she has eaten the leftover pizza. Almost noon and still in her pajamas. And mismatched slippers. Pepperoni. I envy the person who got her identity.

"My greatest concern was what to call it. I thought of calling it 'information', but the word was overly used, so I decided to call it 'uncertainty'. He told me, 'You should call it *entropy*…nobody knows what entropy really is, so in a debate you will always have the advantage."

"You went outside like that?" "It's just the backyard."

"People have windows. Second-*story* "Maybe you should

windows." answer it."

"You know that old woman down the block,

works in her flower garden all the time?"

I do not answer phones, and now all of us know. Ever. The risk is far

risk is too great. I'm trying to come up with something new, break boundaries

A flying fly hits the screen— $Z^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{h}m_{p}{}_{h}{}_{h}$. The phone rings. A little

more matter (*nothing* matters) sucked into the black hole.

"If somebody got our

identity,

every minute

counts."

"She always says something when I

walk

by,

but I have my earphones in and can't what she's saying."

Man: That's quite a lovely Jackson Pollock, isn't it?
Woman: Yes, it is.
Man: What does it say to you?
Woman: It restates the negativeness of the universe. The hideous lonely emptiness of existence. Nothingness. The predicament of man forced to live in a barren, godless eternity like a tiny flame flickering in an immense void with nothing but waste, horror, and degradation, forming a useless, bleak straitjacket in a black, absurd cosmos.
Man: What are you doing Saturday night?
Woman: Committing suicide.
Man: What about Friday night?

$Z^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{h}{}_{m}{}_{p}{}_{h}{}_{h}{}_{h}$.

I walked into a restaurant. Once.

The Maitre d' brought

over a

bottle of , compliments

of the house, had the chef

prepare a special menu not

on the dish.

It was unlike

anything.

"Well?" "I could care less."

"Couldn't. Couldn't care less." "I finally took out my earphones and said

"The way you say it, if you *could* care less, then hello."

you care more than the less you *could* care."

I've tried to make it myself but I'm always missing . She's always there

with the red wheelbarrow, changing the flowers about —making it

new flowers in old positions,

old flowers in new positions, no flowers in some position,

some flowers in none,

one here,

there.

You are him! I *looked* like that man, *talked* like him. No. Yes. But what if she asked, *What do you think*? $Z^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{h}m_{p}{}_{h}{}_{h}{}_{h}$. You *are him*, and hugged me. (The phone…) "She couldn't me." (…rings). The dog barked. $Z^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{h}m_{p}{}_{h}{}_{h}{}_{h}$. Or she? Or maybe she'd ask me to stop for tea and pound cake.

"Tea and cake or death? Tea and cake or death?" I didn't understand. Another ring, time running out.

$Z^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}$

$z_{z}{}_{z}$

$z_{z}{}_{z}{}^{z}{}^{h}$

$m_{p}{}_{h}{}_{h}{}_{h}$.

$Z^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}_{z}{}^{h}m_{p}{}_{h}{}_{h}{}_{h}$. We stared at the phone, hanging on infinity. Obsessed flower gardeners are almost certainly British, possibly. It wasn't s^{o} so $_{s}o$ so s^{o} $_{s}o$ s^{o} bad losing my ident[virgin]ity. Because now she wears earphones.

> "If I had a world of my own, everything would be nonsense. Nothing would be what it is, because everything would be what it isn't. And contrary wise, what is, it wouldn't be. And what it wouldn't be, it would. You see?"

No(n)sense.

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